

CAMPUS CONNECT: UNIFIED STUDENT ONBOARDING PORTAL

A PHP and MySQL- Based Web Application for Academic Management

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Abstract — *The Campus: Unified Student Onboarding Portal is a PHP-based web application designed to simplify and automate major college administrative tasks by integrating four modules—Admin, HOD, Student, and Scholarship Cell—for smooth coordination. The portal replaces manual paperwork and offline approvals with digital processes, enabling online student registration, admission applications, scholarship applications, facility booking, and digital ID card download. Students can manage their accounts and applications, HODs can review requests and handle facility bookings, the scholarship cell can verify scholarship applications, and the admin oversees course management and all approvals. Developed using PHP and MySQL, the system provides key features such as user login, admission processing, scholarship management, facility booking, course management, and ID card generation.*

Key words: Unified Student Portal, Campus Automation, Online Admission, Scholarship Management, Facility Booking System, Course Management, ID Card Generation, Role-Based Access, PHP, MySQL.

I. INTRODUCTION

The rise of computer technology has made it easier to manage repetitive tasks and improve the management of data and Organization. As data is vital in this era, every job relies on having access to information. The Campus Connect: Unified Student Onboarding Portal is software created to handle various administrative activities in a college through an online platform. It allows efficient management of student information, admissions, scholarships, courses, and facility bookings. Students can apply for their admissions and scholarships, download their ID cards, and view their academic information online. The department head can review admission details, and the departments can pre-book facilities in the college. The scholarship cell can view and manage scholarship requests. The principal can manage applications, courses, and all operations. The primary goal of this system is to create a platform that is user-friendly and simplifies college management, saves time, and also improves the coordination between various departments.

II. LITERATURE REVIEW

The academic management system research reveals that the course administration, admissions, scholarships, and facility bookings are increasingly changing from manual procedures to digital platforms. The web-based solutions that are based on PHP and MySQL offer real-time access, increased accuracy, and also related interaction when compared to traditional paperbased systems, which are slow and unreliable. The current systems do not allow departmental coordination, and they usually perform only one single duty, such as admissions or scheduling, but not both. Research studies have already highlighted that the colleges need a single integrated system as it will improve campus automation, make work faster and easier, and increase efficiency. The Campus Connect: Student Onboarding Portal fills this gap by providing various administrative functions such as student registration, admission, scholarship application, facility bookings, and ID card generation, in a single platform, with role-based access.

III. RELATED WORK AND TECHNOLOGY

Traditionally, student onboarding tasks like admissions, document verification, and communication have been executed manually through paper forms and in-person verification. This traditional approach is slow, prone to errors, and lacks interdepartmental coordination. Current digital solutions often suffer from fragmentation and do not offer a comprehensive platform for the entire onboarding process.

Campus Connect: Unified Student Onboarding Portal addresses these challenges by consolidating all onboarding activities into a single system, enabling quicker processing, accurate data management, and real-time monitoring.

Feature	Existing System	Proposed System
Student Admission	Requires physical submission	Online application
Scholarship Processing	Misplacement or delay may occur	Digital submission, quick verification, and approval
Facility Booking	Bookings handled through registers or offline requests	Online bookings and availability of resources can be viewed at the time of booking
Department Coordination	Poor coordination	Smooth communication
Data Accuracy	Errors and duplication may occur	Secure, accurate and error free
Time Efficiency	More time is required	Fast and error-free processing
Accessibility	Task completion occurs only if physical presence is available	Application status can be viewed online
Updates and Modifications	Hard to update and maintain	Easy to update and maintain

System Environment:

- Front End: HTML, CSS, JavaScript (JS)
- Back End: PHP (Open-source general-purpose scripting language)
- Database: My SQL (Relational database management system)

IV. PROBLEM STATEMENT

The primary problem with this project, "Campus Connect: Unified Student Onboarding Portal ", is the inefficiency and lack of clarity present in the processes used in the college administration.

The existing system that depends on physical forms, offline approvals and scattered recordings of data suffers from several critical limitations:

- **High Incidence of Errors:** Manual handling of admission forms, facility booking requests, and scholarship applications increases the possibility of making errors.
- **Lack of Centralized Information:** Student details, course information, scholarship records, and facility bookings are usually maintained in separate files or systems, which makes real-time access and coordination between departments difficult.
- **Operational Inefficiency:** Tasks such as admissions processing, scholarship verification, and facility approvals require more time, repetition may occur, and require a large effort from staff and administrators.
- **Poor Transparency and Tracking:** Students' visibility into application statuses is limited, and departments face significant struggles to track submissions or approvals without any delay.

The goal of Campus Connect: Unified Student Onboarding Portal is to provide a centralized digital platform that removes all these issues by making student registration, admissions, scholarships, course management, facility bookings, and ID card generation into a single automated system.

V. PROPOSED SYSTEM BLOCK DIAGRAM AND MODULES

The proposed system aims to provide a secure, streamlined, and user-friendly platform designed to meet the specific needs of four key modules: User, HOD, Scholarship Cell, and Admin, which ensures smooth coordination and efficient handling of all onboarding processes.

A. Student Modules

- **Login:** This module is used for student login to access their account
- **Admission:** This module allows students to apply for admission through the online portal.
- **Scholarship:** Students can apply for scholarships and view their application status.
- **ID Card:** This module allows students to download their digital ID card.

B. HOD Modules

Login: This module is used for HOD login to access their department functions.

Application Review: The HOD can review student admission and scholarship applications. Facility

Booking: This module allows the HOD to book college facilities such as auditoriums and classrooms for programs or events.

C. Scholarship cell Modules

- **Login:** This module is used for Scholarship Cell login.
- **Application Verification:** Through this module, the Scholarship Cell can review and verify student scholarship applications.
- **Approval/Rejection:** This module allows the Scholarship Cell to approve or reject scholarship requests based on eligibility.

D. Scholarship cell Modules

- Login: This module is used for the Principal to log in and manage system operations.
- Course Management: Through this module, the Principal can add, update, or manage course details.
- Scholarship Approval: The Principal can finalize the approval or rejection of scholarship applications.
- Facility Management: The Principal can review and approve facility bookings made by departments.
- Student Monitoring: This module allows the Principal to view student details and applications.

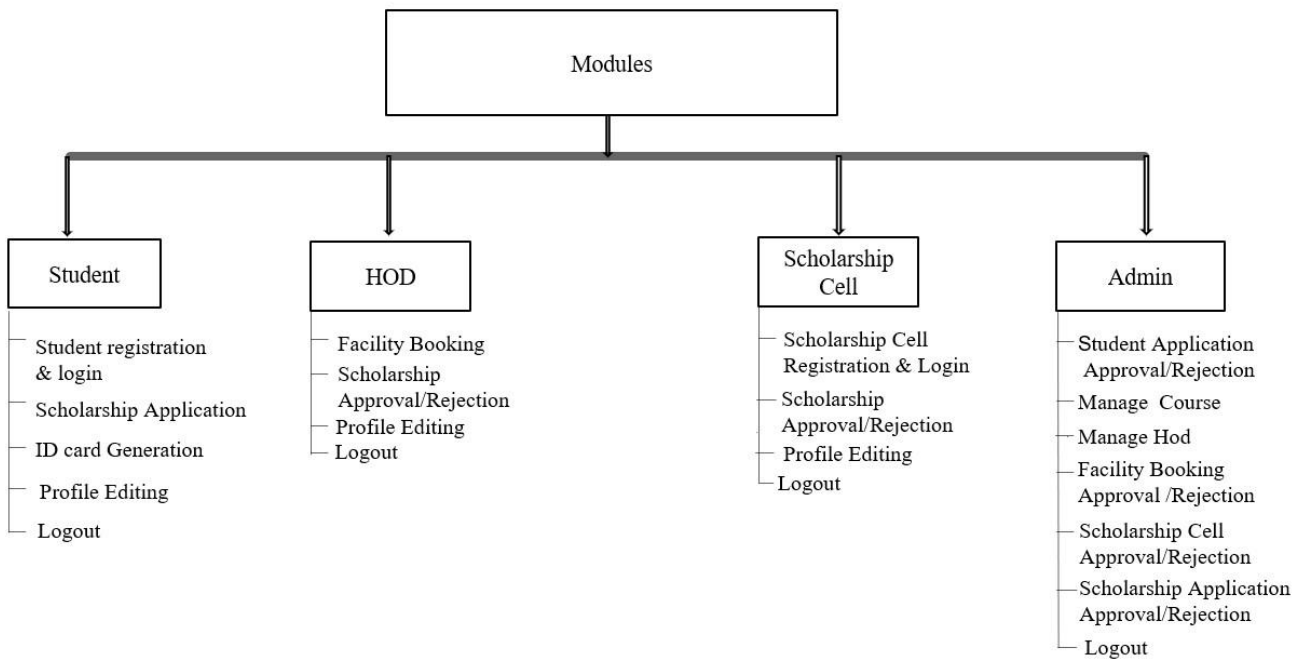


Fig 1. Block Diagram of the System

VI. METHODOLOGY

Methodology refers to the systematic process or approach used to design, develop, and implement a project. It includes the steps, tools, and techniques followed to achieve the project's objectives efficiently and accurately.

Student Module Flowchart

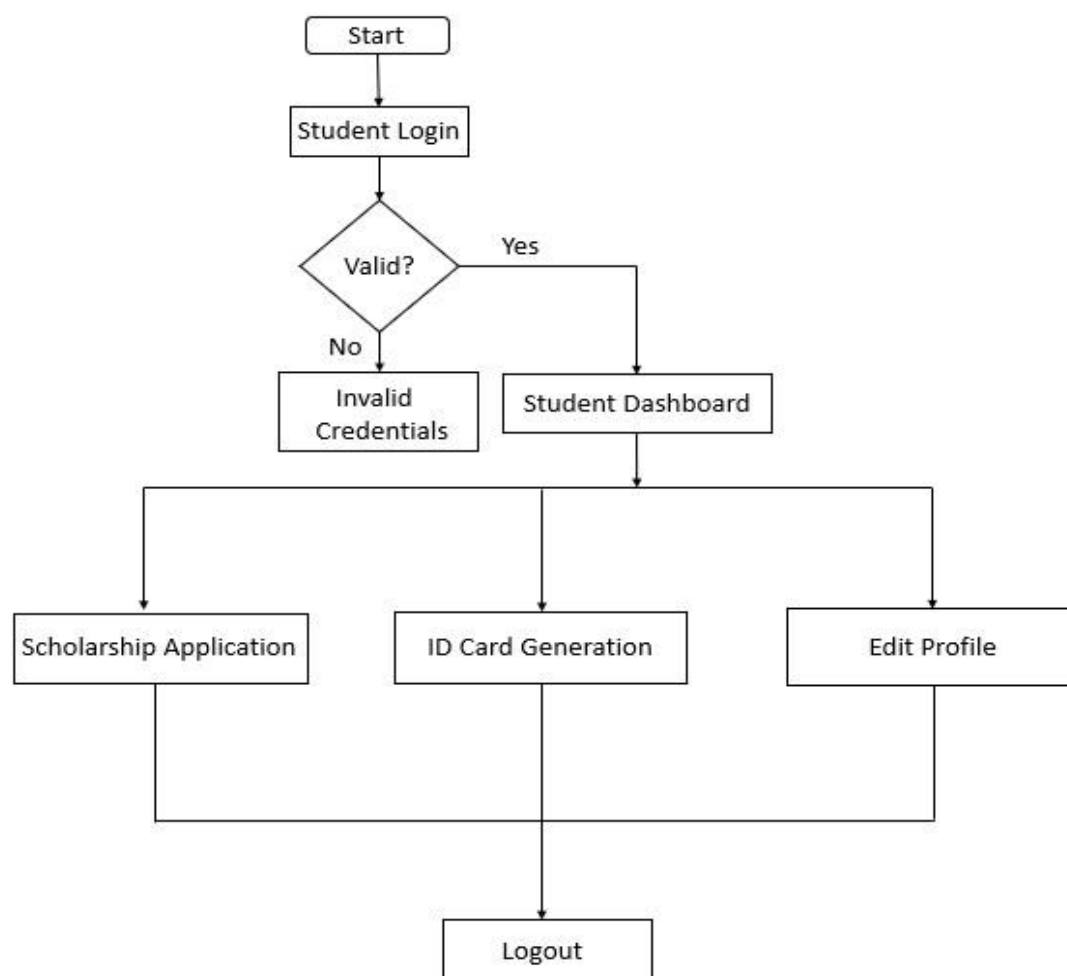


Fig 2: Student Module Flowchart

The student module flowchart illustrates the workflow of the Student Module within the system. It outlines how a student interacts with the platform, starting from login to performing various actions available on the dashboard. The process begins when the student initiates the system. The student is prompted to enter their login credentials (username and password). The system verifies whether the entered credentials are correct. If the credentials are valid, the student is granted access to the Student Dashboard. Once logged in, the student is navigated to the dashboard, which acts as the central hub for available services. The dashboard provides options for:

- **Scholarship Application:** The student can apply for scholarships by filling in the required details and submitting documents through the system.
- **ID Card Generation:** This option allows the student to request or generate their digital ID card.
- **Edit Profile:** The student can update personal information, contact details, and other profile-related data.

If the credentials are invalid: After completing the required activities, the student logs out of the system, ending the session. The system displays an "Invalid Credentials" message. The student may retry the login process.

HOD Module Flowchart

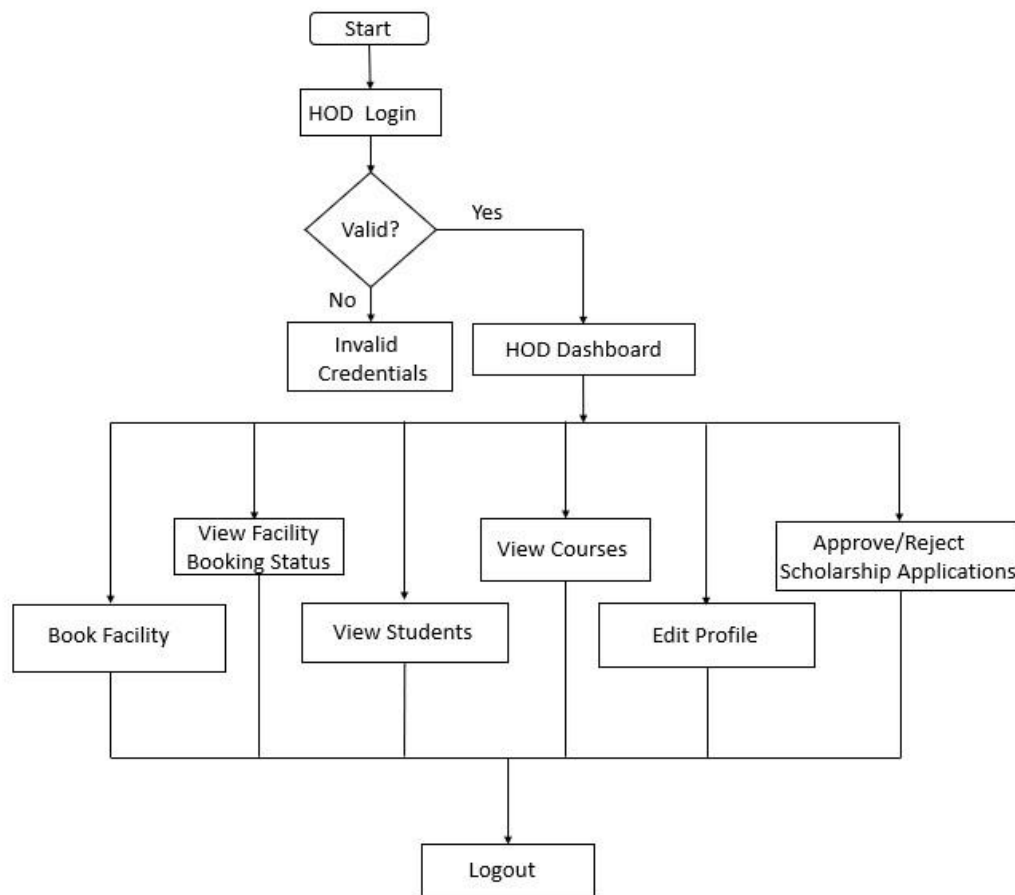


Fig 3: HOD Module Flowchart

The HOD flowchart represents the workflow of the Head of Department (HOD) Module in the system. It outlines the steps followed by the HOD from logging in to carrying out various administrative tasks. The process begins when the HOD accesses the system. The HOD enters their login credentials to access the system. The system checks whether the provided credentials are correct. If the credentials are valid, the HOD is redirected to the HOD Dashboard. If the credentials are invalid:

An "Invalid Credentials" message is displayed, prompting the HOD to retry login. After successful login, the HOD is directed to the main dashboard. From here, the HOD can access and manage various sections of the system.

The dashboard provides access to the following functionalities:

- **Book Facility:** The HOD can book different facilities such as laboratories, seminar halls, or other department resources as required.
- **View Facility Booking Status:** The HOD can view current and past facility bookings to track availability and usage.
- **View Students:** The HOD can access the list of students under the department, including their basic details and academic information.
- **View Courses:** This option allows the HOD to view available courses, course details, and assigned faculty information.
- **Edit Profile:** The HOD can update personal information such as contact details, profile picture, or login password.
- **Approve/Reject Scholarship Applications:** The HOD can review scholarship applications submitted by students and either approve or reject them based on eligibility and documentation.

Once all tasks are completed, the HOD logs out of the system, ending the session.

Scholarship Cell Module Flowchart

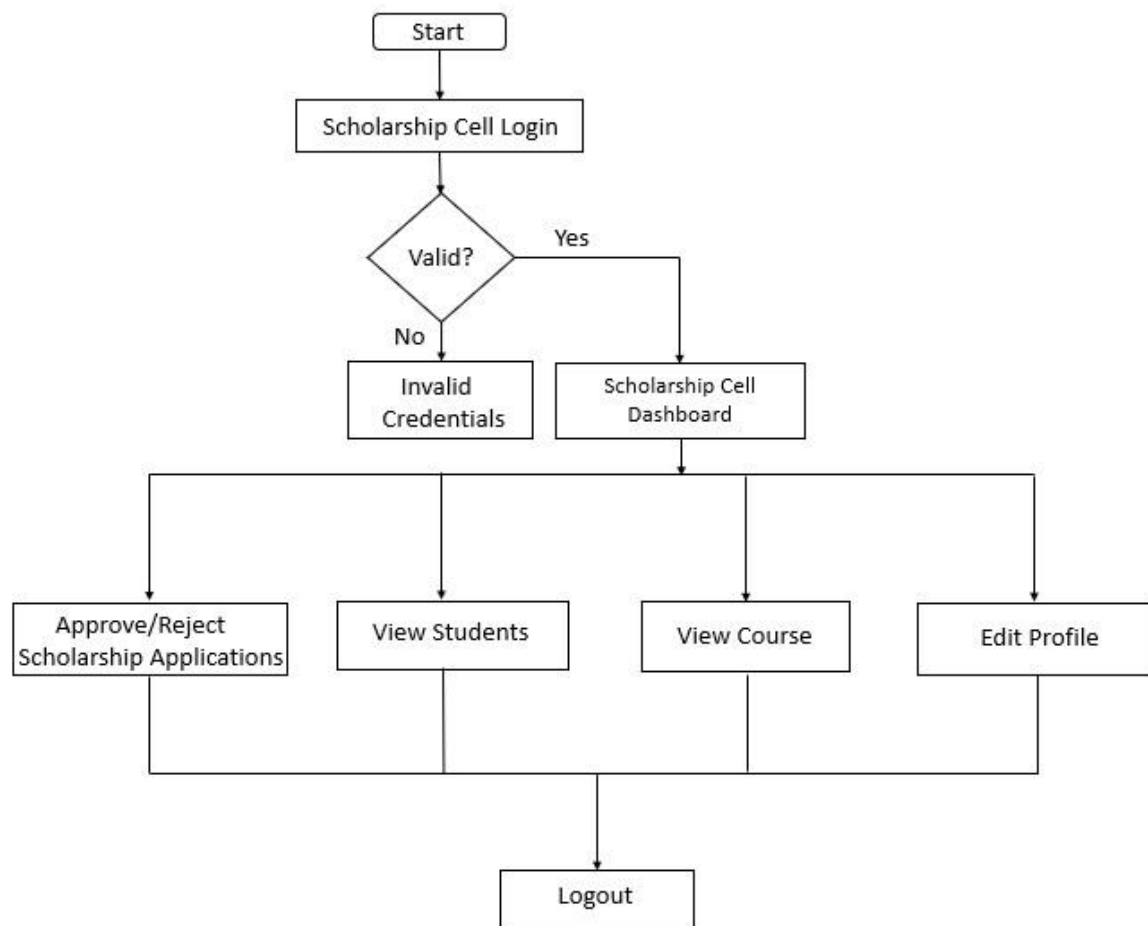


Fig 4: Scholarship Cell Module Flowchart

The Scholarship Cell module flowchart shows the steps the Scholarship Cell takes while using the system. It details the process from logging in to carrying out various scholarship and administrative tasks. The process starts when the Scholarship Cell user accesses the system. The staff member enters their login details, including username and password, to get into the system. The system checks if the entered details are correct. If they are valid, the user is taken to the Scholarship Cell Dashboard. If they are invalid, the system displays an "Invalid Credentials" message, asking the user to try logging in again. After a successful login, the user arrives at the dashboard, which offers access to several functions. The dashboard includes these modules:

- **Approve/Reject Scholarship Applications:** The Scholarship Cell can view all submitted scholarship applications, check eligibility, review supporting documents, and approve or reject applications accordingly.
- **View Students:** This module allows the Scholarship Cell to see student details, such as personal information, academic records, and application status.
- **View Course:** The user can look at course details, including course codes, departments, and student enrollment information.
- **Edit Profile:** The Scholarship Cell user can update their personal information, contact details, or login password as needed. Once all tasks are finished, the user logs out of the system to end the session securely.

4. Admin Module Flowchart

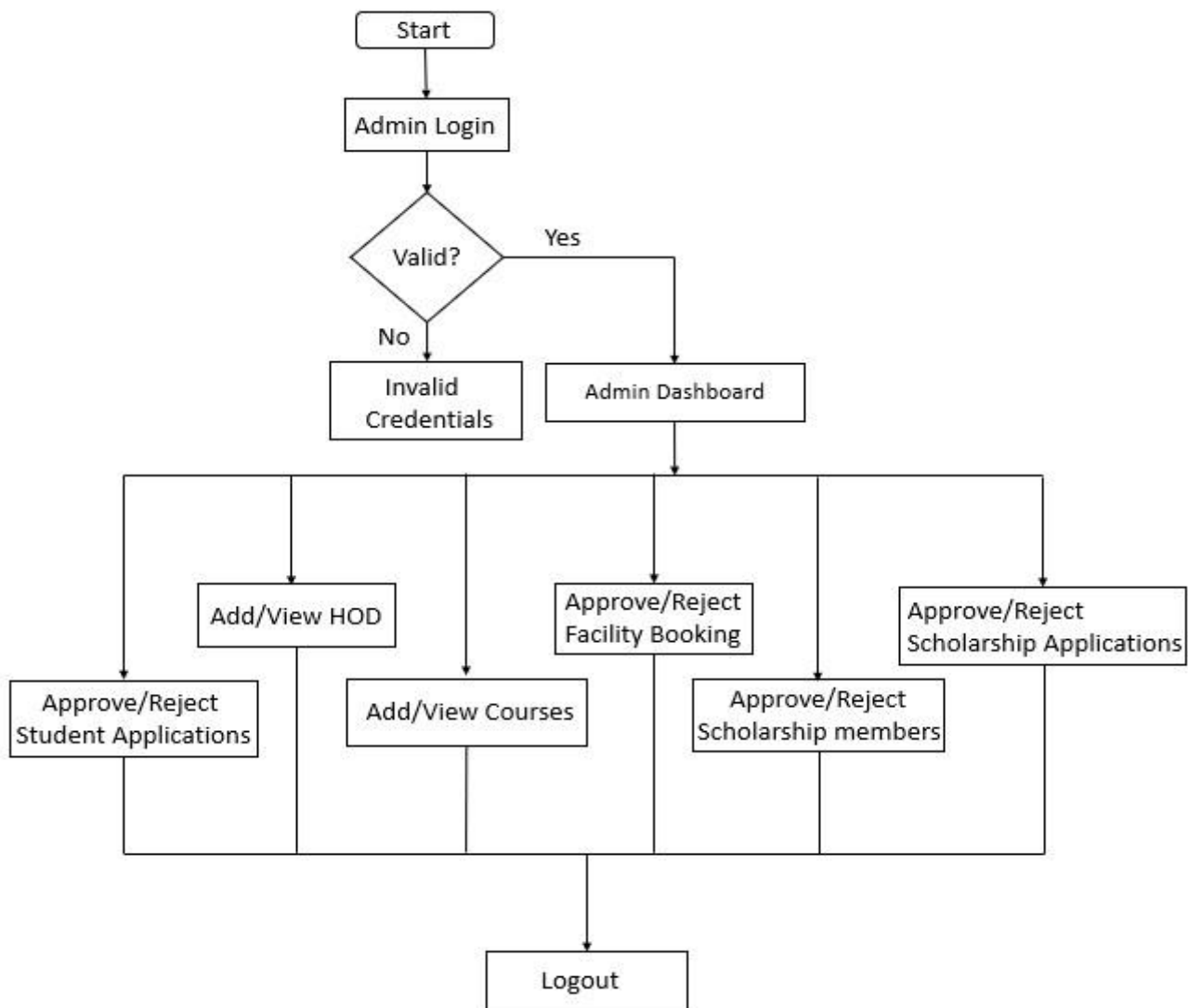


Fig 5: Admin Module Flowchart

The admin module flowchart illustrates the complete workflow of the Admin Module, showcasing how the administrator manages users, applications, and system operations. The process begins when the admin user opens or accesses the system. The admin enters their username and password to access the system. The system verifies the accuracy of the entered credentials. If credentials are valid, the system redirects the user to the Admin Dashboard. If credentials are invalid, an "Invalid Credentials" message is displayed, and the admin is prompted to re-enter correct login details. Upon successful login, the administrator gains access to the dashboard where all system management functionalities are available. From here, the admin can navigate to multiple modules:

- **Approve/Reject Student Applications:** The admin can view all student onboarding or registration applications and either approve or reject them based on validation and eligibility.
- **Add/View HOD:** The admin can create new HOD accounts, update details, or view existing HOD profiles.
- **Add/View Courses:** This module allows the admin to add new courses, update existing course details, or view the list of all courses offered by the institution.
- **Approve/Reject Facility Booking:** The admin can manage and authorize facility booking requests placed by students, staff, or departments.
- **Approve/Reject Scholarship Members:** The admin can approve or reject members belonging to the scholarship committee or scholarship review panel.
- **Approve/Reject Scholarship Applications:** The admin has the authority to manage all scholarship applications submitted by students and make approval or rejection decisions.

After completing all required operations, the admin logs out of the system, ending the session securely.

VII. FEATURES AND BENEFITS

The Campus Connect platform offers a secure and effective digital solution aimed at streamlining and enhancing key academic and administrative functions of a college. It incorporates automation, real-time updates, and role-specific access to facilitate effortless communication and collaboration among administrators, HODs, students, and the scholarship cell.

1. Role-Specific Access:

The platform provides secure and tailored interfaces for various user groups—Admin, HOD, Students, and Scholarship Cell. Each user has access only to the tools and information pertinent to their position, enhancing data security and operational effectiveness.

2. Online Admission and Course Enrollment:

Students are able to apply for admission and enroll in courses online. All applications are updated in real-time within the system, eliminating paperwork and reducing errors in comparison to conventional manual processing.

3. Scholarship Application Oversight:

Students can submit scholarship applications electronically, allowing the Scholarship Cell to evaluate, approve, or decline requests. The admin receives the final approval requests, ensuring a seamless and transparent process for scholarship approvals.

4. Digital ID Card Issuance:

Students can conveniently download their digital ID cards from the portal. This function removes the delays linked to manual ID production and ensures quick access during academic events.

5. Facility Reservations and Approvals:

HODs can reserve college facilities through the portal, with the admin able to approve or deny these requests swiftly. This automation helps prevent scheduling conflicts and promotes efficient utilization of campus facilities.

6. Immediate Reports and Analytics:

Admins can access comprehensive reports on admissions, course registrations, scholarship applications, and facility usage. This facilitates superior monitoring, quicker decision-making, and enhanced transparency across departments.

VIII. DISCUSSION

The Campus Connect platform is a comprehensive digital solution aimed at providing easy access and effective management of key academic and administrative functions. It improves communication between administrators, department heads, students, and the scholarship office by incorporating real-time updates, automated processes, and secure access based on user roles. A significant advantage of Campus Connect is its capacity to minimize manual tasks and enhance the accuracy of data through digital processes for admissions, course enrollments, scholarship management, and facility reservations. The system guarantees that all information is kept in a centralized database, thereby enhancing transparency and reliability among various departments. Furthermore, Campus Connect improves user experience by offering features like the ability to download digital ID cards, generate reports instantly, and track applications in real time. These capabilities help prevent delays, reduce human errors, and establish a more organized workflow for both staff and students. Nonetheless, the system necessitates a reliable internet connection for optimal performance, and users must be familiar with basic digital procedures to achieve the best results. Future improvements may involve the integration of a mobile app, biometric verification, AI-powered notifications, and further automation functionalities to enhance campus operations even more.

IX. CONCLUSION

The Campus Connect: Unified Student Onboarding Portal is a comprehensive web-based system that effectively simplifies and automates major college operations. By integrating modules for admission, course registration, digital ID cards, scholarship management, and facility booking, the system ensures smooth coordination among administrators, HODs, students, and the scholarship cell. The portal significantly reduces manual errors, saves time, and enhances communication between departments. With its secure role-based access and real-time updates, Campus Connect ensures efficient handling of academic and administrative tasks. Ultimately, this project improves the overall operational efficiency, transparency, and digital readiness of the institution. It supports a modernized academic environment and lays the foundation for future enhancements and automation.

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